

China Materials: Your cheatsheet to navigate the sector in 2Q26

Structure intact, but macro noise takes the wheel

Equities
Metals and Mining

China

- ◆ Aluminium remains most preferred; copper and gold positive but near-term macro pressure; lithium momentum intact
- ◆ We move paper to neutral; steel, cement and glass remain weak with policy the key swing factor
- ◆ We like Hongqiao and Chalco, Zijin mining and Zijin Gold, CMOC and CNM and Ganfeng

Aluminium (most preferred): Aluminium continues to offer the strongest fundamentals within China materials. Capacity ceiling keeps domestic supply tight, while overseas markets are increasingly constrained as Middle East tensions have added a new layer of supply risk. Near-term domestic inventory build may cap upside, but downside is limited given widening LME–SHFE spread (>RMB3,000/t) that could drive exports. Over the medium term, constrained global supply, rising energy costs and geopolitical risks should continue to support both physical and pricing premiums (see [Metals Quarterly Q2 2026](#), 13 April 2026). We continue to favour Hongqiao on yield and Chalco-H/A's overseas ambitions.

Copper (positive but near-term macro pressure): Copper prices remain resilient (>USD12,000/t), supported by tight micro fundamentals, such as inventory drawdown, negative TC/RCs and ongoing supply disruptions (e.g. Kamoanga guidance cuts). However, macro headwinds are weighing on near-term sentiment and driving volatility. While the market may focus on demand uncertainty in the short term, we believe structural drivers remain intact, including supply constraints, declining ore grades and demand electrification and AI-related consumption. Additional risks such as sulphur shortages for African smelters and further mine disruptions could tighten balances further. As macro concerns stabilise, the market is likely to refocus on tightening fundamentals. We prefer Zijin-H/A, and also like CMOC and CNM.

Gold (positive but near-term macro pressure): Gold prices remain elevated but volatile, with near-term pressure from USD liquidity tightening, position unwinds and intermittent selling to stabilise currencies. However, structural support remains intact, driven by central bank reserve diversification in the longer term. While gold equities may take time to bottom given limited near-term catalysts, we view recent pullbacks as attractive additional opportunities. We like Zijin Gold for its earnings growth visibility.

Lithium (positive, but much priced in): Lithium fundamentals have improved since 2H25, supported by supply disruptions and strong ESS-driven demand. In the near term, prices should remain firm at around RMB150k/t, supported by low inventories and solid downstream production schedules. However, the market remains highly sensitive to policy changes and marginal shifts in supply-demand balance, and much of the recovery is already reflected in share price. We like Ganfeng for its execution, cost advantages and rising self-sufficiency (see [China Lithium: Tightening fundamentals, but much priced in](#), 14 April 2026).

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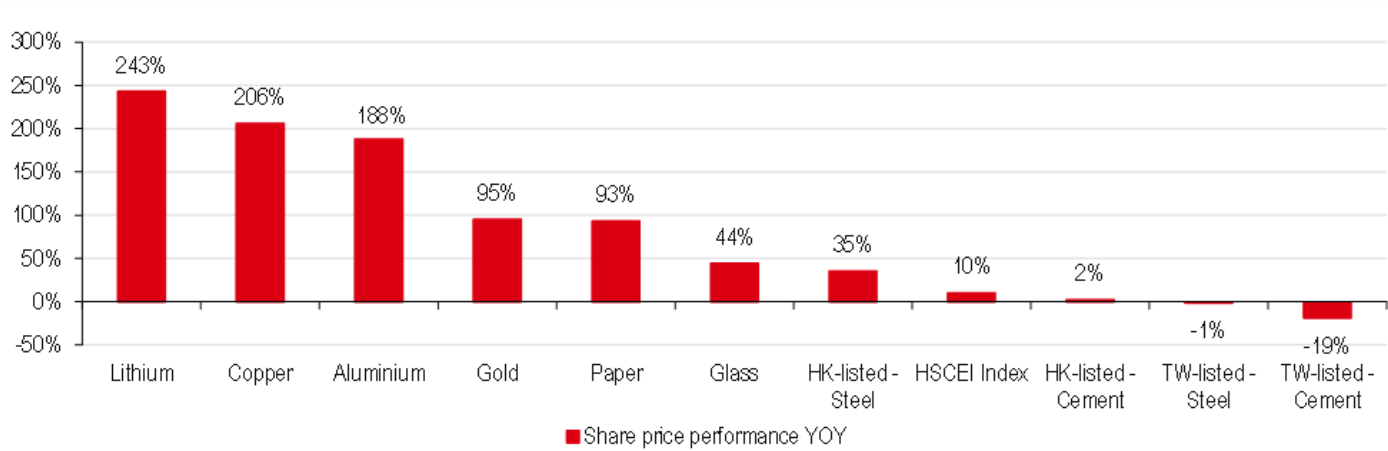
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Exhibit 1: Key ratings and estimates

Company	Ticker	Currency	Current price	TP	Rating	Upside downside	Market cap (USDbn)	3m ADTV (USDm)	2026e PE (x)	2026e PB (x)	2026e Div. yield
China Hongqiao	1378 HK	RMB	38.36	41.00	Buy	6.9%	48.6	209	9.8	2.5	4.6
Chalco-H	2600 HK	RMB	12.43	15.20	Buy	22.3%	30.1	105	8.6	2.6	1.9
Chalco-A	601600 CH	RMB	12.35	14.90	Buy	20.6%	30.1	768	9.4	2.8	1.8
Zijin Mining - H	2899 HK	HKD	36.48	58.00	Buy	59.0%	129.7	397	11.1	3.5	1.1
Zijin Mining - A	601899 CH	RMB	33.75	50.00	Buy	48.1%	129.7	1,889	11.3	3.6	1.1
CMOC - H	3993 HK	HKD	18.45	24.90	Buy	35.0%	57.7	154.6	12.0	3.5	1.7
CMOC - A	603993 CH	RMB	18.96	25.20	Buy	32.9%	57.7	970.8	13.6	3.9	1.5
China Nonferrous	1258 HK	HKD	12.58	14.10	Buy	12.1%	6.3	37.2	10.7	2.0	2.7
Zijin Gold	2259 HK	RMB	183.00	269.00	Buy	47.0%	62.5	N/A	17.3	5.5	1.1
Ganfeng Lithium - H	1772 HK	HKD	79.05	92.00	Buy	16.4%	24.7	129.5	30.0	2.9	0.2
Ganfeng Lithium - A	002460 CH	RMB	83.98	98.00	Buy	16.7%	24.7	642.0	35.1	3.4	0.2

Source: Bloomberg estimates, HSBC, priced at close of 10 April 2026.

Exhibit 2: 12 months' share price performance



Source: Bloomberg, HSBC

Aluminium (most preferred)

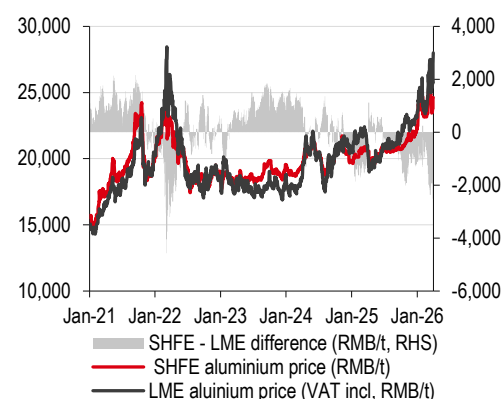
Among China materials, aluminium continues to offer the strongest fundamentals. In March, China's average aluminium price reached RMB24,350/t (+4% m-o-m, +cRMB1,000/t), with industry profitability remaining exceptionally strong. Smelting margins exceeded RMB8,000/t by end-March, supporting full capacity utilisation, with operating rates already at the policy cap of 45mt. On the demand side, downstream restarts were delayed due to the later Chinese New Year in 2026 (mid-February vs. late January in 2025). Combined with historically high operating levels and limited room for supply adjustment, this has led to continued inventory builds into early April.

In contrast, LME aluminium inventories remain at c476kt, near historically low levels. This reflects: (1) ongoing disruption risks around the Strait of Hormuz, which continue to impact global aluminium supply chains; and (2) persistent trade frictions (e.g. US tariffs), which keep cross-border logistics costs elevated. In addition, supply risks in the Middle East (e.g. Emirates Global Aluminium and Aluminium Bahrain) remain a key overhang for global supply.

For 2Q26, elevated domestic inventories are likely to cap near-term upside in SHFE aluminium prices, which we expect to trade in the RMB24,000–25,000/t range. That said, downside risk appears limited. Firm LME pricing provides a strong external floor, while the LME–SHFE price spread (>RMB3,000/t) is increasingly attractive, potentially incentivising arbitrage exports and helping to tighten the domestic supply-demand balance. Once domestic inventories begin to destock, current price pressure could reverse into a positive catalyst.

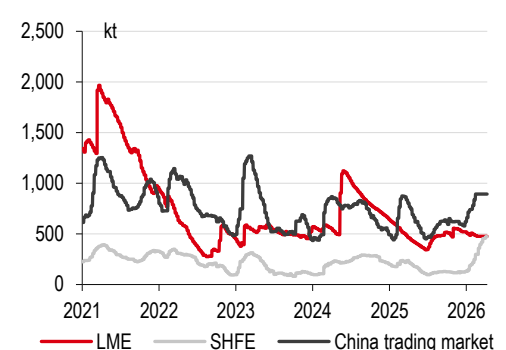
Looking further ahead, ex-China supply expectations have tightened meaningfully. Disrupted Middle East capacity is unlikely to fully recover in the near term given long restart timelines. At the same time, limited new capacity additions, constrained by power availability, reinforce supply tightness. Against a backdrop of low overseas inventories, rising energy costs, and higher freight costs for bauxite, both physical and geopolitical premiums are increasing. Overall, we see aluminium moving into a structurally tighter balance through the year.

Exhibit 3: Aluminium Price trend



Source: LSEG Datastream, HSBC

Exhibit 4: Aluminium inventory (kt)



Source: LSEG Datastream, Bloomberg, HSBC

Exhibit 5: 2026 industry margin

2026 Aluminium		Y-o-Y
Price		↑
Cost		↑
- Power tariff		=/↑
- Alumina		=/↑
- Bauxite		=/↑
- Carbon anode		=/↑
Margin		↑

Source: HSBC estimates

Note: ↓ means decline; ↑ means increase; = means flat

Source: Wood Mackenzie, Bloomberg, HSBC estimates

Copper (Positive but near-term macro pressure)

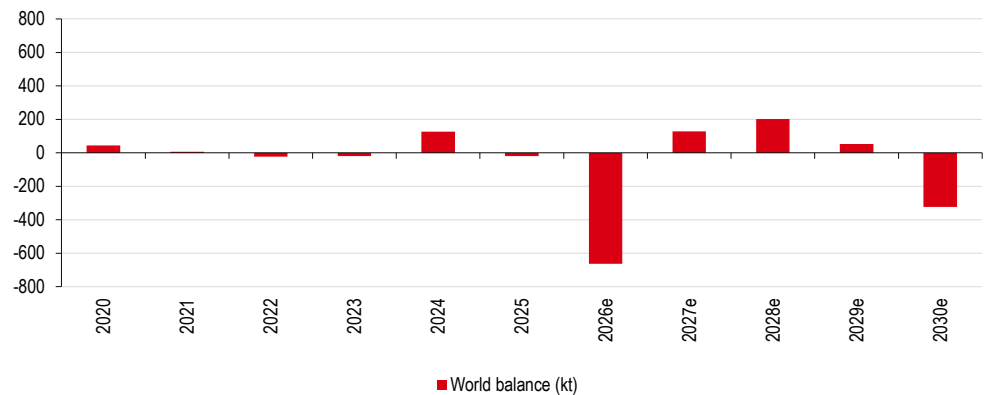
Copper prices have remained resilient, staying well above USD12,000/t despite Middle East tensions (vs. 2025 average of USD9,941/t), supported by solid underlying fundamentals.

On the domestic side: (1) copper inventories have started to draw down, indicating improving downstream buying following the recent price pullback; (2) TC/RCs continue to deteriorate (TC at around negative USD69/t), signalling tight concentrate supply; and (3) smelter maintenance in April–May (per Mysteel) is expected to reduce refined copper output by 40–50kt (c3% m-o-m). Overseas, supply disruptions are also emerging. Ivanhoe Mines has materially lowered 2026–27 production guidance for the Kamo-a-Kakula complex due to geotechnical and dewatering challenges, with 2026 output now guided at 290–330kt (vs. 380–420kt previously).

The recent pullback in copper equities can be attributed to several factors: (1) softer commodity prices; (2) capital rotation away from pro-cyclical sectors amid macro uncertainty; (3) prior share price strength had priced in optimistic sentiment; and (4) shifting macro expectations—rising inflation concerns potentially delaying rate cuts, alongside a stronger USD weighing on demand. As a result, near-term market focus is likely to remain on weaker GDP expectations and softer demand signals.

That said, we believe macro uncertainty affects the upside rather than the direction of copper price moves. The structural drivers behind the previous re-rating remain intact: (1) supply-side constraints (mine disruptions, resource nationalism, underinvestment, and declining ore grades); (2) emerging demand drivers (renewables and AI-related power demand); and (3) broader macro considerations around USD creditworthiness. In addition, Middle East tensions could further accelerate investment in electrification and energy security.

Looking into 2Q26, incremental supply disruptions—such as potential sulphur shortages (critical for African smelters) or further mine shortfalls—could prompt the market to reprice supply deficit risks. With valuations now more reasonable, we believe that once near-term macro concerns are digested, the market will refocus on tightening copper fundamentals.

Exhibit 6: Global copper market balance


Source: Wood Mackenzie, HSBC estimates

Gold (Positive but near-term macro pressure)

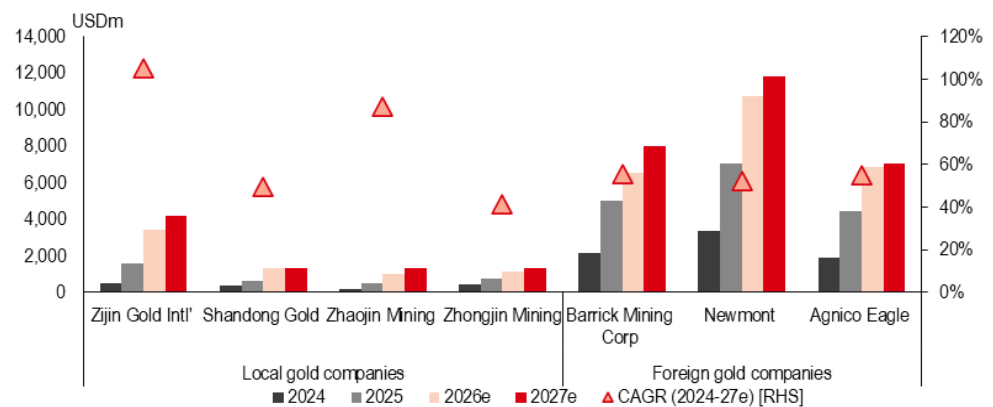
Gold prices remain elevated at cUSD4,800/oz (vs. 1Q26 average of USD4,897/oz) amid ongoing geopolitical tensions, although near-term volatility remains high, with positioning and USD liquidity dynamics driving day-to-day price movements.

In the short term, gold faces downside pressure from several factors: (1) liquidation of leveraged positions, leading to selling of liquid assets such as gold; (2) temporary tightening in USD liquidity, as higher energy prices increase global demand for US dollars to fund oil purchases; and (3) selective gold sales by some countries to stabilise their currencies. These factors help explain the recent weakness in gold prices despite persistent geopolitical uncertainty.

Over the medium to longer term, we remain constructive on gold equities: First, the ongoing “de-dollarisation” trend and central bank reserve diversification continue to provide structural support. According to the World Gold Council, China added 5t of gold in March (its 17th consecutive monthly purchase), marking the largest monthly increase since February 2025. Second, while the recent oil price spike has created near-term inflationary pressures that weigh on gold, a prolonged period of elevated energy prices could shift market focus toward growth risks. Under a potential recessionary scenario, expectations for more accommodative monetary policy could re-emerge, which would be supportive for gold as a non-yielding asset. As such, we expect the medium-term gold narrative to reassert itself once macro conditions stabilise.

Gold equities broadly track gold prices but with higher volatility. In the near term, the above factors are weighing on gold prices, leading to a sharp correction. With limited visibility on near-term catalysts, gold equities may take time to bottom, despite intermittent rebounds driven by price movements, easing geopolitical tensions, or improved market risk appetite.

That said, given our constructive medium-term outlook, we think the recent pullback creates additional attractive opportunities in gold equities.

Exhibit 7: Earnings comparison of local and foreign gold companies


Source: HSBC estimates (for Zijin Gold, Shandong Gold, and Zhaojin); Bloomberg estimates for the rest

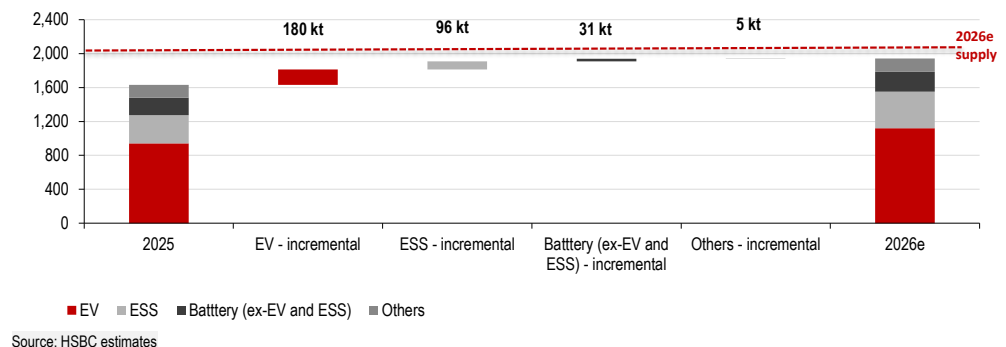
Lithium (Positive, but much priced in)

Since 2H25, lithium has shown clear signs of a turnaround, with near-term sentiment improving on the back of stronger demand expectations and a low inventory-to-production ratio.

On the supply side, in February 2026, Zimbabwe imposed a ban on mineral concentrate exports, which was later revised in April to allow exports under a quota system tied to domestic lithium sulphate capacity commitments. While mine restarts may bring incremental supply, they are unlikely to fully offset this shortfall. We estimate Zimbabwe's export restrictions could reduce global supply by c40kt LCE in 2026. At the same time, demand remains robust, primarily driven by rapid growth in energy storage systems (ESS). Lithium demand is forecast to grow 19% y-o-y in 2026 and at a 13% CAGR through 2030. This combination of constrained supply and resilient demand has driven a sharp rebound in lithium prices from trough levels.

In the near term, we expect prices to remain firm at around RMB150k/t, supported by low inventories, strong downstream production schedules in April–May, and temporary disruptions to Zimbabwe ore shipments. Upside risks remain if further supply disruptions or stronger-than-expected demand materialise. However, the market remains highly sensitive to news flow, given policy-driven supply uncertainty, marginal shifts in inventories and demand, and the evolving spread between spodumene and lithium chemicals. Risks remain on both sides: supply could normalise if Zimbabwe resumes exports more fully, while EV demand visibility remains somewhat uncertain.

Among our coverage, we see Ganfeng Lithium as better positioned to deliver earnings growth, driven by higher lithium chemicals output (~230kt), upstream ramp-up (Goulamina and Cauchari-Olaroz), rising self-sufficiency (>60%) supporting structural cost reductions, and continued expansion in batteries and ESS. This should enhance profitability through scale and provide additional leverage to price strength (see [China Lithium: Tightening fundamentals, but much priced in](#), 14 April 2026).

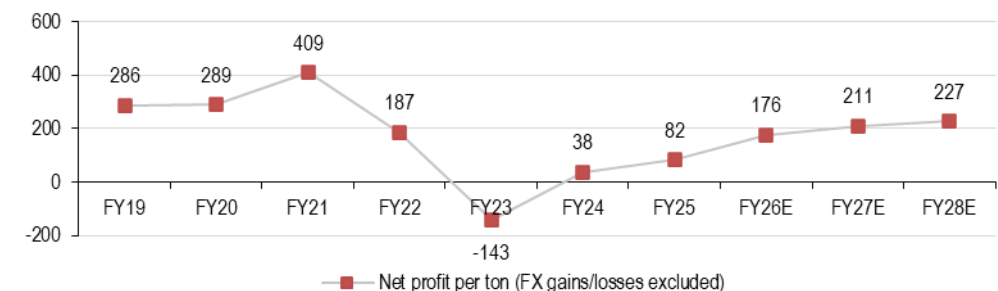
Exhibit 8: EV + ESS key driver for lithium demand


Packaging Paper (move to neutral from positive)

The paper market has shifted from multi-week price hikes to a demand-driven correction, with prices diverging across segments. In early April, containerboard (linerboard/corrugated medium) prices remained broadly stable, while white card prices declined by cRMB100/t m-o-m. Leading producers such as Nine Dragons Paper and Lee & Man Paper have cut ex-mill prices. Overall, amid weak seasonal demand, the market has entered a cyclical correction phase, with pricing power shifting from sellers to buyers.

Demand remains the key constraint. Weak end-consumer demand, coupled with softer export orders in certain regions, led downstream enterprises to adopt a cautious, need-based purchasing approach. Traders maintain a neutral outlook and have trimmed prices to facilitate sales and reduce inventories. On the supply side, paper mills have largely maintained stable operating rates with limited shutdown plans, leaving supply relatively ample. In terms of costs, pulp pressures have eased – pulp futures inventory rose to 191kt in early April (+5kt w-o-w), while international pulp prices remained stable. Lower pulp costs provide margin support, but in a weak demand environment, this also intensifies price competition.

Looking into 2Q26, we expect demand to remain soft in the near term due to the traditional off-season. Market stabilisation will likely depend on meaningful supply-side contraction (e.g. maintenance shutdowns) alongside a seasonal recovery in demand. For our paper coverage, we see limited near-term catalysts.

Exhibit 9: Net profit/ton trend (RMB/t)


Source: Company data, HSBC estimates

Steel (neutral; policy-dependent)

Steel remains range-bound with limited fundamental momentum, trading largely as a function of input costs and marginal shifts in supply-demand balance. Entering April, the pace of supply recovery has outpaced demand. Blast furnace operating rates and utilisation have both increased, with molten iron output rising to c2.4mt per day – a relatively high level.

On the demand side, construction activity has improved sequentially but remains weaker y-o-y, while flat products are relatively more resilient, supported by exports and early signs of manufacturing restocking (March PMI new orders returned to expansion). As domestic prices soften, China's export competitiveness has improved, keeping steel exports relatively resilient. Structurally, infrastructure remains the main support for demand, while property demand continues to lag due to slow fund disbursement and low project starts, resulting in an overall sluggish recovery. On the cost side, Middle East-related uncertainties have increased volatility in input prices, although near-term energy supply remains stable, providing continued cost support.

Looking into 2Q26, resilient raw material costs and steady exports should provide a floor for steel prices, with potential for short-term rebounds. However, the rapid increase in output in April, combined with demand likely peaking seasonally (typically late April), could shift the balance back toward oversupply and renewed pressure on prices.

From an investment perspective, China's steel sector remains structurally challenged by persistent oversupply and compressed margins amid declining demand. The anti-involution campaign launched in July 2025 aims to curb disorderly competition through stricter capacity replacement rules and accelerated closure of outdated or non-compliant facilities.

For 2026, we expect steel prices to remain soft, with weak demand from both property and infrastructure. A meaningful turning point is unlikely to come from demand recovery or export growth. Instead, policy support is likely to emerge toward late 2026, as local inspections conclude and emissions-upgrade deadlines approach, gradually narrowing the supply surplus and stabilising pricing and margins. Policy influence should deepen further in 2027 with the expansion of the national carbon emissions trading scheme, raising compliance costs and tightening constraints for higher-emission producers (see [China steel: 2026 Outlook: From "Involution" to structural rebalance](#), 25 November 2025).

Exhibit 10: China Steel S-D table

in mt	2022	2023	2024	2025e	2026e	2027e
China Crude Steel Production	1018	1029	1005	961	922	895
y-o-y		1.1%	-2.3%	-4.4%	-4.0%	-3.0%
Finished Steel Consumption	927	905	857	809	769	738
Property	242	206	174	136	111	90
Infrastructure	215	228	214	205	193	182
Construction (property and infrastructure)	457	433	388	342	304	272
Machinery	143	133	124	115	108	101
Auto	66	69	70	72	73	74
Others	262	270	275	281	285	291
Apparent Crude Steel Consumption (mt)	961	938	888	839	797	765
y-o-y		-2.4%	-5.3%	-5.6%	-5.0%	-4.0%
Net export (import) of steel products	57	84	104	112	117	122
Surplus/Deficit	0	7	12	10	8	7

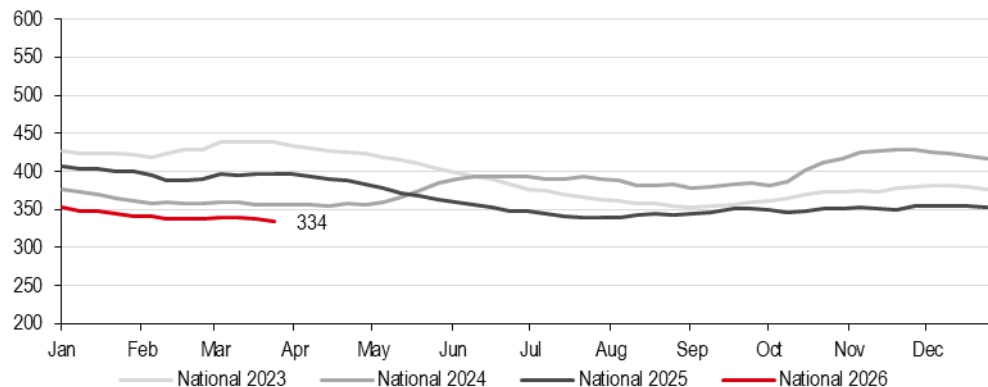
Source: Wind, World Steel Association, HSBC estimates

Cement (neutral; policy-dependent)

Entering April, cement prices continue to trend lower, primarily driven by weak demand and limited supply-side support. On the demand side: (1) shipment volumes remain below y-o-y levels, with recovery progressing only gradually; property-related demand continues to face pressure, while infrastructure demand is relatively more resilient, supported by adequate funding.

On the supply side, there have been no meaningful policy updates. While off-peak production curbs have increased y-o-y, weak demand and elevated inventory levels have made them difficult to sustain in certain regions. As a result, prices remain soft and under pressure. Looking into 2Q26, we expect limited demand improvement given seasonal headwinds, including the farming and rainy seasons during May-June. For our cement coverages, we should watch for gradual demand normalisation and any tighter supply-side policies or more effective enforcement. Beyond these, we see limited near-term catalysts for the sector.

Exhibit 11: National average cement prices (RMB/t)



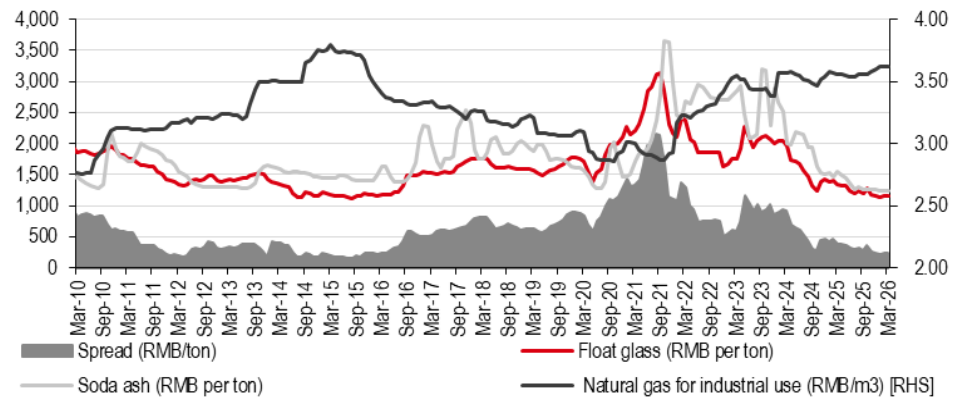
Source: Digital Cement, HSBC

Glass (neutral)

Glass prices remained weak through March and early April with futures prices hitting new lows. This was mainly driven by: (1) lacklustre downstream demand; and (2) high inventories across the industry chain.

On the supply side, production curtailments have been limited and fragmented, making it difficult to reverse the loose supply backdrop. Although daily output has declined to around 140kt (vs. 151kt/day by end-2025), inventories continue to build and remain elevated given sluggish demand. As a result, the industry has entered a loss-making phase. That said, we believe further downside is limited. Rising energy prices amid geopolitical tensions should provide cost support, while sustained losses may trigger additional cold repairs, helping to constrain supply.

Looking into 2Q26, we expect glass prices to remain volatile but range-bound. A meaningful price recovery would require either a clear improvement in supply-demand fundamentals or a sustained increase in energy costs, neither of which is evident at this stage.

Exhibit 12: ASP, unit cost and spread of float glass


Source: Bloomberg, Wind, CEIC, HSBC

Valuation and risks

Valuation		Risks
China Hongqiao 1378 HK Buy	Current price: HKD38.36 Target price: HKD41.00 Upside: +6.9%	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of HKD41.00. This target price is based on a forward PE multiple of 10.0x (unchanged) and is set at 2SD above the historical average. The same PE multiple is applied to Chalco, reflecting our positive outlook for 2026. Our valuation uses a 2026 estimated EPS of RMB3.55 (unchanged) and incorporates our FX team's end-2026 RMB/HKD exchange rate forecast of 1.16 (unchanged). Our target price of HKD41.00 implies 6.9% upside to the current share price, and we maintain our Buy rating based on aluminium's structural supply constraints, resilient demand, and Hongqiao's long-term earnings potential. Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625
Chalco-H 2600 HK Buy	Current price: HKD12.43 Target price: HKD15.20 Upside: +22.3%	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of HKD15.20. This target price is based on a forward PE multiple of 10.0x (unchanged) and is set at 1SD above the historical average to reflect our positive outlook for 2026, driven by potential supply disruptions and robust demand. We apply it to our 2026 EPS estimate of RMB1.31 (unchanged), using an RMB-HKD FX rate forecast of 1.16 (unchanged). Our H-share target price implies c22% upside, and we maintain our Buy rating as we see solid fundamentals and are optimistic on the margin outlook for aluminium. Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625
Chalco-A 601600 CH Buy	Current price: RMB12.35 Target price: RMB14.90 Upside: +20.6%	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of RMB14.90. The same forward PE multiple of 10.0x is applied as Chalco-H, reflecting comparable performance to the H-share in 2025. This is based on our 2026 EPS estimate of RMB1.31 (unchanged), with an A-H premium of 10% to account for the current A-share premium. The A-share target price implies 20.6% upside, and we maintain our Buy rating given the solid fundamentals and positive margin outlook for aluminium. Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625
Zijin Mining-H 2899 HK Buy	Current price: HKD36.48 Target price: HKD58.00 Upside: +59.0%	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of HKD58.00. We use a forward PE multiple of 15.0x (unchanged) applied to our 2027e EPS estimate of RMB3.32 (unchanged) based on an end-2025e HKD-RMB exchange rate of 1.16 (unchanged). Our target P/E multiple is c1.5SD above the historical average P/E multiple since 2016. We maintain Buy on 59% upside, reflecting our positive outlook for both copper and gold, the successful spin-off of Zijin Gold, stable output growth, continued efforts on M&A, and potential demand growth from policy rate cuts. Taken together, we expect solid fundamentals of stable earnings growth, strong operational capability with respect to production and cost controls, and acquisitions that help long-term resources and production growth. Furthermore, a higher copper and gold price on rate cut is favourable to Zijin's earnings. Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625
		Downside risks: 1) Lower-than-expected demand from property completions and renewables; 2) new resources and environmental regulations adopted by the mining industry that could lead to higher production costs; 3) lower-than-expected payout ratio; and 4) bauxite supply disruption.
		Downside risks: 1) Lower-than-expected demand from property completions; 2) new resources and environmental regulations adopted by the mining industry that could lead to higher production costs; 3) higher-than-expected R&D expense and impairment loss; 4) bauxite supply disruption; 5) inventory impairment loss amid declining alumina price; and 6) geopolitical risks when acquiring overseas resources.
		Downside risks: 1) Lower-than-expected demand from property completions; 2) new resources and environmental regulations adopted by the mining industry that could lead to higher production costs; 3) higher-than-expected R&D expense and impairment loss; 4) bauxite supply disruption; 5) inventory impairment loss amid declining alumina price; and 6) geopolitical risks when acquiring overseas resources.
		Downside risks: (1) Delays in construction of new capacity; (2) lower metal prices; (3) geopolitical conflicts in overseas mines; (4) overambitious M&A transactions that burden financials and pull up production cost; and (5) higher production costs due to inflation, declining ore grading, and/or stricter emission standards for mining.

		Valuation	Risks
Zijin Mining-A 601899 CH Buy	Current price: RMB33.75 Target price: RMB50.00 Upside: +48.1%	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of RMB50.00. For our A-share target price, we apply no A-H share premium (unchanged) and a forward PE multiple of 15.0x (the same as the H-share). Our target P/E multiple is c1.5SD above the historical average P/E multiple since 2016. We maintain Buy on c48% upside, reflecting our positive outlook for both copper and gold, the successful spin-off of Zijin Gold international, stable output growth, continued efforts on M&A, and potential demand growth from policy rate cuts. Taken together, we expect solid fundamentals of stable earnings growth, strong operational capability with respect to production and cost controls, and acquisitions that help long-term resources and production growth. Furthermore, a higher copper and gold price on rate cut is favourable to Zijin's earnings. Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625	Downside risks: (1) Delays in construction of new capacity; (2) lower metal prices; (3) geopolitical conflicts in overseas mines; (4) overambitious M&A transactions that burden financials and pull up production cost; and (5) higher production costs due to inflation, declining ore grading, and/or stricter emission standards for mining.
CMOC-H 3993 HK Buy	Current price: HKD18.45 Target price: HKD24.90 Upside: +35.0%	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of HKD24.90. This target price is based on a forward PE multiple of 15.0x (unchanged) and is consistent with historical average. We apply it to our 2026 EPS estimate of RMB1.46 (unchanged), using an RMB-HKD FX rate forecast of 1.13 (unchanged). Our H-share target price implies 35.0% upside, and we maintain our Buy rating as CMOC's solid fundamentals and supportive long-term growth outlook. Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625	Downside risks: 1) Increases in new copper mine supply and copper scrap that more than offsets copper demand growth and, in turn, puts pressure on copper prices; 2) political risk in the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC); 3) delays in the shipment of cobalt in the DRC under the quota system; and 4) technology developments that could reduce cobalt usage in electric batteries.
CMOC-A 603993 CH Buy	Current price: RMB18.96 Target price: RMB25.20 Upside: +32.9%	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of RMB25.20. This target price is based on a forward PE multiple of 15.0x (unchanged) and is c0.5SD below the historical average. We apply it to our 2026 EPS estimate of RMB1.46 (unchanged), and apply an A-H share premium of 15% (unchanged) to reflect the current A-share premium of the stock. Our A-share target price implies c33% upside, and we maintain our Buy rating as CMOC's solid fundamentals and supportive long-term growth outlook. Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625	Downside risks: 1) Increases in new copper mine supply and copper scrap that more than offsets copper demand growth and, in turn, puts pressure on copper prices; 2) political risk in the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC); 3) delays in the shipment of cobalt in the DRC under the quota system; and 4) technology developments that could reduce cobalt usage in electric batteries.
China Nonferrous Mining 1258 HK Buy	Current price: HKD12.58 Target price: HKD14.10 Upside: +12.1%	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of RMB14.10. This target price is based on a forward PE multiple of 12.0x (unchanged), which aligns with our valuation approach for other Chinese copper companies, and is 2 SD above its historical average to reflect the strong copper market fundamentals, driven by structural demand from renewables and AI data centres, and supply disruptions. We apply our target multiple to our 2027e EPS estimate of USD0.15 (unchanged), after applying a USD-HKD exchange rate of 7.80 (unchanged). Our target price implies 12.1% upside from the current share price and we keep Buy rating reflecting robust copper fundamentals as we expect a deficit market in 2026. Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625	Downside risks: 1) Earnings fluctuations from commodity price changes; 2) delays to project expansions; 3) lower ore grades and environmental compliance risks; and 4) geopolitical risk of overseas mines.
Zijin Gold 2259 HK Buy	Current price: HKD183.00 Target price: HKD269.00 Upside: +47.0%	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of HKD269.00. We derive our target price by applying a forward PE multiple of 22x (unchanged) to EPS of USD1.57 (unchanged) and an FX rate of 7.8 HKD/USD (unchanged). Our target multiple reflects Zijin Gold's broader asset platform and above-peer earnings growth outlook, with an expected earnings CAGR of 42% in 2025-28e (unchanged). We believe our valuation multiple captures rising output, cost competitiveness, and the company's ability to acquire high-quality gold assets. Meanwhile, every 1% movement in gold prices or sales volume results in a 1.8% or 1.0% change in 2027 earnings, respectively, providing additional upside potential if the gold cycle strengthens. Our target price implies 47% upside to the current market price. We maintain our Buy rating given Zijin Gold's expanding production base, improving margins, and strong leverage to gold. Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625	Downside risks: 1) Earnings volatility from gold price movements; 2) rising capital expenditure and financial pressure; 3) overseas M&A and geopolitical risks; 4) cost inflation and operational constraints; and 5) post-lock-up share price risk.

		Valuation	Risks
Ganfeng-H 1772HK	Current price:	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of HKD92.00. We derive our target price by applying a forward PB multiple of 3.25x (unchanged), which is 0.5 SD above historical average since 2019, to our 2026 BVPS estimate of RMB24.55 (unchanged), with FX rate of 1.16. Our target price implies 16.4% upside to the current price. We keep our Buy rating because we see potential upside to lithium price amid the strong EV+ESS demand and lingering supply disruption.	Downside risks: 1) Longer-than-expected ramp-up time of its upstream projects, lithium chemical plants, and battery plants; 2) trade tension between China and Australia could impact spodumene imports; 3) lower-than-expected demand growth from EV and ESS; and 4) lower-than-expected investment income amid lower lithium price.
	Target price:		
	Upside:		
Buy	HKD79.05 HKD92.00 +16.4%	Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625	
Ganfeng-A 002460CH	Current price:	Valuation: We maintain our Buy rating and TP of RMB98.00. We derive our target price by applying a forward PB multiple of 4.0x (unchanged), to our 2026 BVPS estimate of RMB24.55 (unchanged). Our target P/B of 4.0x is in line with the historical average since 2019. Our target price implies 16.7% upside. We keep our Buy rating, eyeing potential lithium price upside amid the strong EV+ESS demand and lingering supply disruption.	Downside risks: 1) Longer-than-expected ramp-up time of its upstream projects, lithium chemical plants, and battery plants; 2) trade tension between China and Australia could impact spodumene imports; 3) lower-than-expected demand growth from EV and ESS; and 4) lower-than-expected investment income amid lower lithium price.
	Target price:		
	Upside:		
Buy	RMB83.98 RMB98.00 +16.7%	Howard Lau howard.h.b.lau@hsbc.com.hk +852 2996 6625	

Priced at close 10 April 2026
 Source: HSBC estimates

Disclosure appendix

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*A stock was classified as volatile if its historical volatility had exceeded 40%, if the stock had been listed for less than 12 months (unless it was in an industry or sector where volatility is low) or if the analyst expected significant volatility. However, stocks which we did not consider volatile may in fact also have behaved in such a way. Historical volatility was defined as the past month's average of the daily 365-day moving average volatilities. In order to avoid misleadingly frequent changes in rating, however, volatility had to move 2.5 percentage points past the 40% benchmark in either direction for a stock's status to change.

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HSBC & Analyst disclosures

Disclosure checklist

Company	Ticker	Recent price	Price date	Disclosure
ALUMINUM CORP OF CHINA A	601600.SS	12.16	13 Apr 2026	4, 11
ALUMINUM CORP OF CHINA H	2600.HK	12.22	13 Apr 2026	4, 11
CHINA HONGQIAO	1378.HK	37.52	13 Apr 2026	4, 11
CHINA NONFERROUS MINING	1258.HK	13.33	13 Apr 2026	–
CMOC GROUP LIMITED	3993.HK	18.35	13 Apr 2026	4, 7, 11
CMOC GROUP LIMITED A	603993.SS	18.86	13 Apr 2026	4, 7, 11
GANFENG LITHIUM	1772.HK	79.80	13 Apr 2026	4, 6, 7, 11
GANFENG LITHIUM A	002460.SZ	84.38	13 Apr 2026	4, 6, 7, 11
Zijin Gold International	2259.HK	183.00	13 Apr 2026	11
ZIJIN MINING	2899.HK	36.60	13 Apr 2026	4, 11
ZIJIN MINING A	601899.SS	33.66	13 Apr 2026	4, 11

Source: HSBC

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